

Dental Center Pediatrics

Plymouth, MA

Pediatric Behavior Management Techniques

Informed Consent for Parents and Legal Guardians

It is our intent that all professional care delivered shall be of the highest possible quality, in a manner that leaves your child with positive feelings about dental visits. Our entire focus is on your child — building trust, fostering good dental health habits, and instilling a healthy attitude toward dentistry for life.

All efforts are made to gain your child's cooperation through warmth, friendliness, humor, gentleness, and understanding. In some cases, additional behavior management techniques are necessary to complete treatment safely. These techniques are never used as punishment — they are standard of care in pediatric dentistry, used only when necessary to protect your child and complete treatment effectively.

Techniques Used at This Practice

1. Tell-Show-Do

The dentist or assistant explains what will be done using simple, age-appropriate language, demonstrates on a model or finger, and then performs the procedure as described. Praise is used to reinforce cooperative behavior.

2. Positive Reinforcement

Cooperative behavior is rewarded with compliments, praise, a pat on the back, or a small prize. This builds trust and encourages continued cooperation.

3. Voice Control

A controlled change in voice volume, tone, or pace is used to redirect the child's attention and guide behavior — not to frighten or scold.

4. Mouth Props / Rubber Dams

A mouth prop (we call it a 'tooth pillow') helps the child keep their mouth open comfortably during treatment. A rubber dam (a 'raincoat') isolates the area being treated to prevent debris from reaching the throat.

5. Protective Stabilization

The dentist or assistant gently stabilizes the child's hands, upper body, head, or legs to prevent sudden movements that could cause injury during treatment. This is used only when necessary and always as briefly as possible.

Parent Acknowledgment

The behavior management techniques described above have been explained to me. I understand that none of these techniques are used as punishment, that they are standard pediatric dental practice, and that they are used only when necessary to provide the safest and best possible dental care for my

child.

I have been encouraged to ask questions, and all questions have been answered to my satisfaction. I authorize the use of the necessary management techniques to assist in the provision of required dental treatment for my child or legal ward. I understand this consent remains in effect until terminated by me in writing.